

SQL

MBUA 512

Class 3 – SQL

SQL = Structured Query Language, "es-queue-el" or "sequel". With Michael Winikoff.

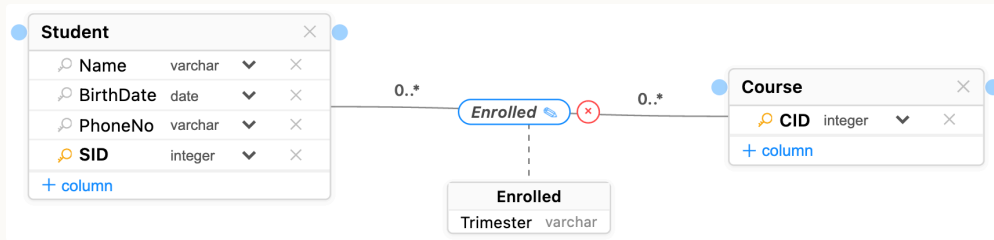
Recap from last week (database design):

1. Data modelling using diagrams
2. Translating diagrams to relational databases, and the role of *keys*
3. Anomalies, and avoiding them by *normalisation*

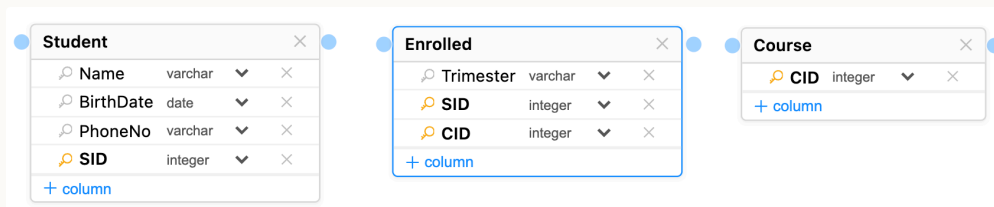
Based on slides by Professor Markus Luczak-Roesch.

Class 2 review

1. **Data modelling using diagrams:** ER diagrams showing entities with (*typed*) attributes and relationships (which can have attributes); *cardinalities*; *keys*.



2. **Translating diagrams to relational databases:** map entities to tables and relationships to tables or additional columns depending on cardinality; *foreign keys*

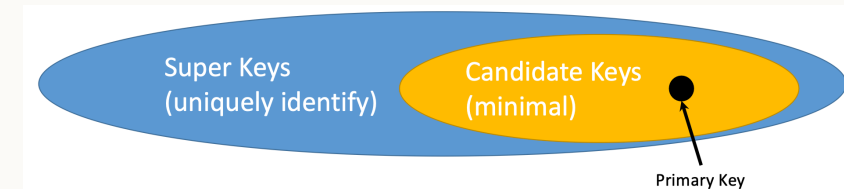


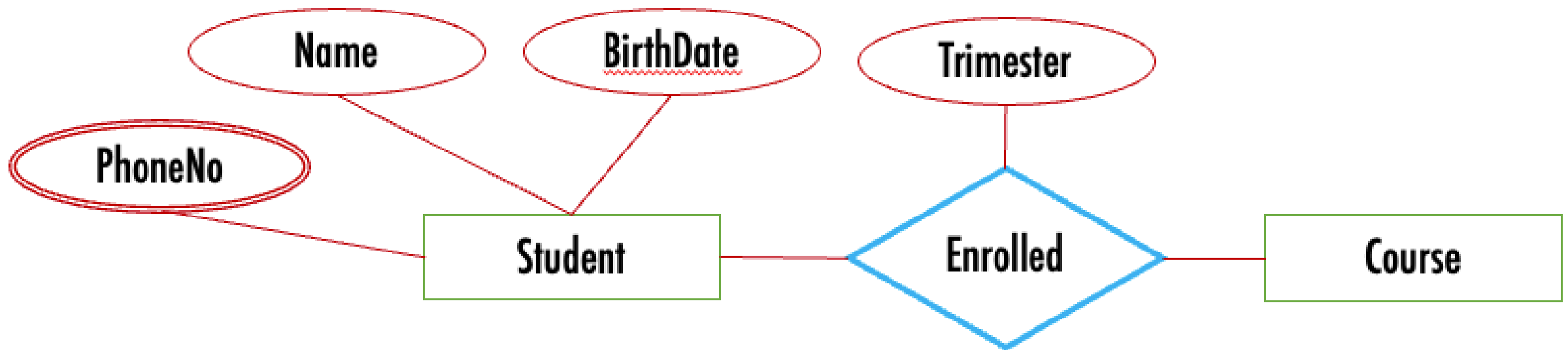
3. **Anomalies and normalisation:** remember 3 steps: identify dependencies; classify them (with respect to the key); normalise by breaking up table

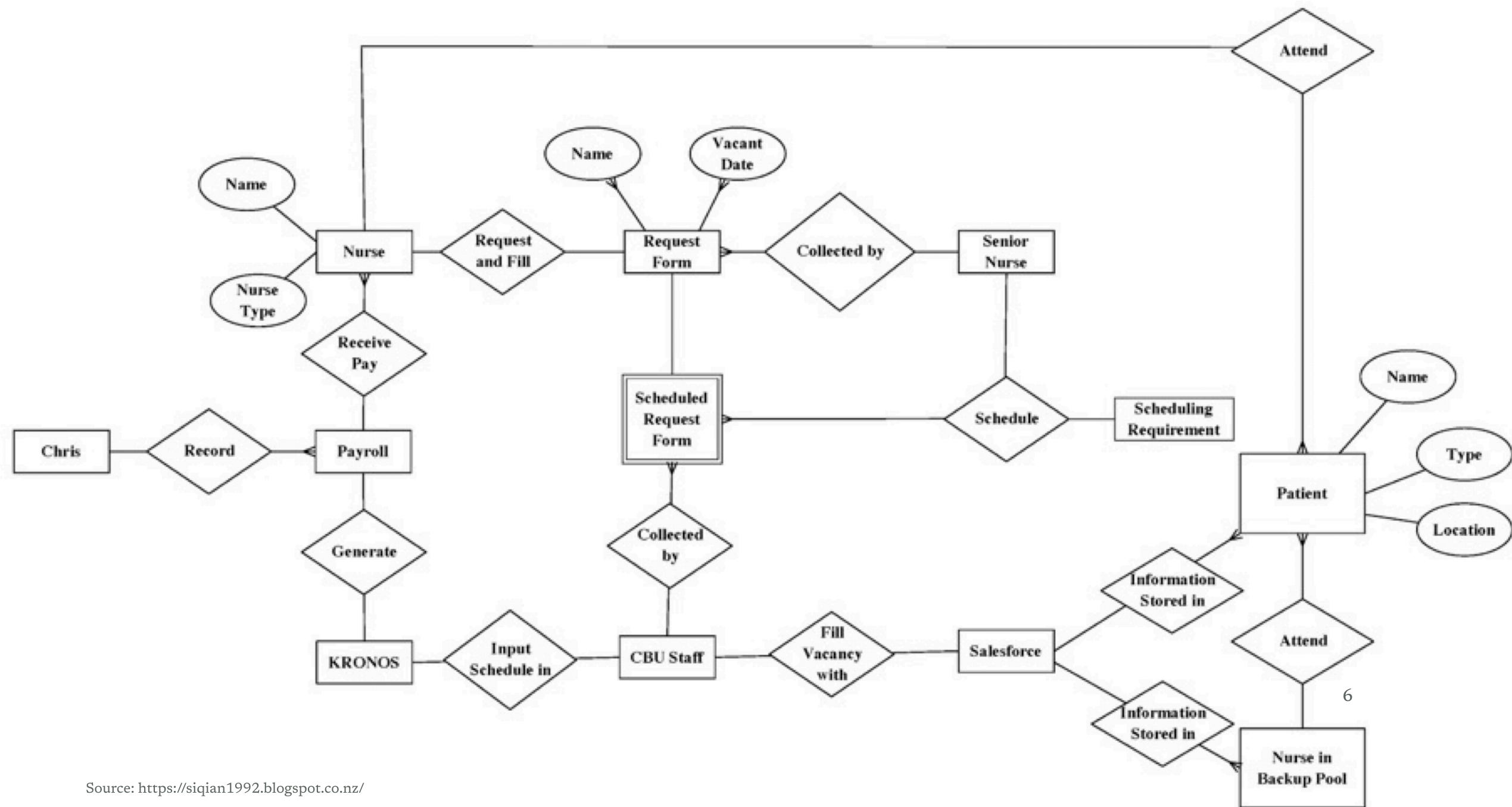
Identifying a primary key

In the table below what would be possible choices for a primary key? Why?

Flight Number	Airline	Day	Time	Pilot ID	Pilot Name	Plane model	Plane manufacturer
NZ123	Air NZ	10 Aug 2018	10am	PL8715	Pat Smith	Airbus310	AirBus
NZ456	Air NZ	11 Aug 2018	11am	PL8716	Yi Zhang	Airbus320	AirBus
YA789	Yugoslav Air	17 Aug 2018	10:30am	PL9781	Jim Belich	Boeing737	Boeing
NZ123	Air NZ	12 Aug 2018	10am	PL9781	Jim Belich	Boeing737	Boeing
NZ124	Air NZ	13 Aug 2018	11pm	PL9781	Jim Belich	Airbus310	Airbus
YA890	Yugoslav Air	17 Aug 2018	4pm	PL9781	Jim Belich	Airbus310	Airbus
...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...







SQL commands

- `CREATE TABLE` and `ALTER TABLE` - define the structure of a table (its *schema*)
- `INSERT INTO` and `DELETE FROM` and `UPDATE` - change the data in the table
- `SELECT` - query data

(there are a lot more than these)

Important: make sure you select your own workspace (`user_[username]`)

CREATE TABLE

```
CREATE TABLE name (  
    column_name data_type,  
    column_name data_type,  
    ...  
)
```


Data types

- Integer / Int – 12 , -14
- Varchar(length) – a string, 'Hello!' (variable-length characters; use single quotes)
- Real – 3.14 , -9.8345 (floating point, inexact)
- Decimal – 3.29 (exact, up to 38 digits)
- Varbinary – binary data
- Date – DATE '2026-12-31' (year-month-day, with the optional word DATE)
- Time – TIME '01:58:36.77' (with the optional word TIME ; also a time-with-time-zone)

CREATE TABLE – example

```
CREATE TABLE people (  
    personID INTEGER PRIMARY KEY,  
    firstName VARCHAR(30) NOT NULL,  
    lastName VARCHAR(30),  
    birthdate DATE NOT NULL,  
    planner INTEGER,  
    email VARCHAR(30),  
    FOREIGN KEY(planner) REFERENCES people(personID)  
);
```

Constraints: PRIMARY KEY, FOREIGN KEY, NOT NULL

ALTER TABLE

`ALTER TABLE` changes the definition of an existing table.

```
ALTER TABLE name ADD COLUMN column_name data_type
```

```
ALTER TABLE people ADD COLUMN prefName VARCHAR
```

```
ALTER TABLE name DROP COLUMN column_name
```

```
ALTER TABLE people DROP COLUMN email -- loses data!
```

```
ALTER TABLE name RENAME COLUMN old_name to new_name
```

```
ALTER TABLE people RENAME COLUMN prefName to preferredName
```

INSERT INTO

```
INSERT INTO table_name (columns...) VALUES (vals...), ...
```

Single quotes are for strings, **double quotes** for database objects.

```
INSERT INTO people VALUES
    (1, 'Bob', 'Smith', '1917-01-03', 1, NULL),
    (2, 'Bob', 'Smith', '1973-03-25', NULL, 'bob@smith.net'),
    (3, 'Alice', 'Smith', '2026-07-07', 1, 'Alice@smith.net');
```

the (columns...) is optional

Importing from a CSV

To generate rows from a CSV: ask an LLM, or use a spreadsheet with a few formulae (next slide).

Prompt: "Convert the following CSV into an SQL statement to insert the data into an ANSI database"

Using a spreadsheet

- use `= " ' " & A2 & " ' "` to convert each string cell into a quoted string
- use `= " ( " & TEXTJOIN( " , " , FALSE , D2 : F2 ) & " ) , " "` to join cells into a single row
- put `INSERT INTO people VALUES` in the first row
- copy and paste the rows
- demo ... (see separate short video)

DELETE FROM table

```
DELETE FROM table WHERE conditions
```

Leaving out the WHERE deletes **all** rows!

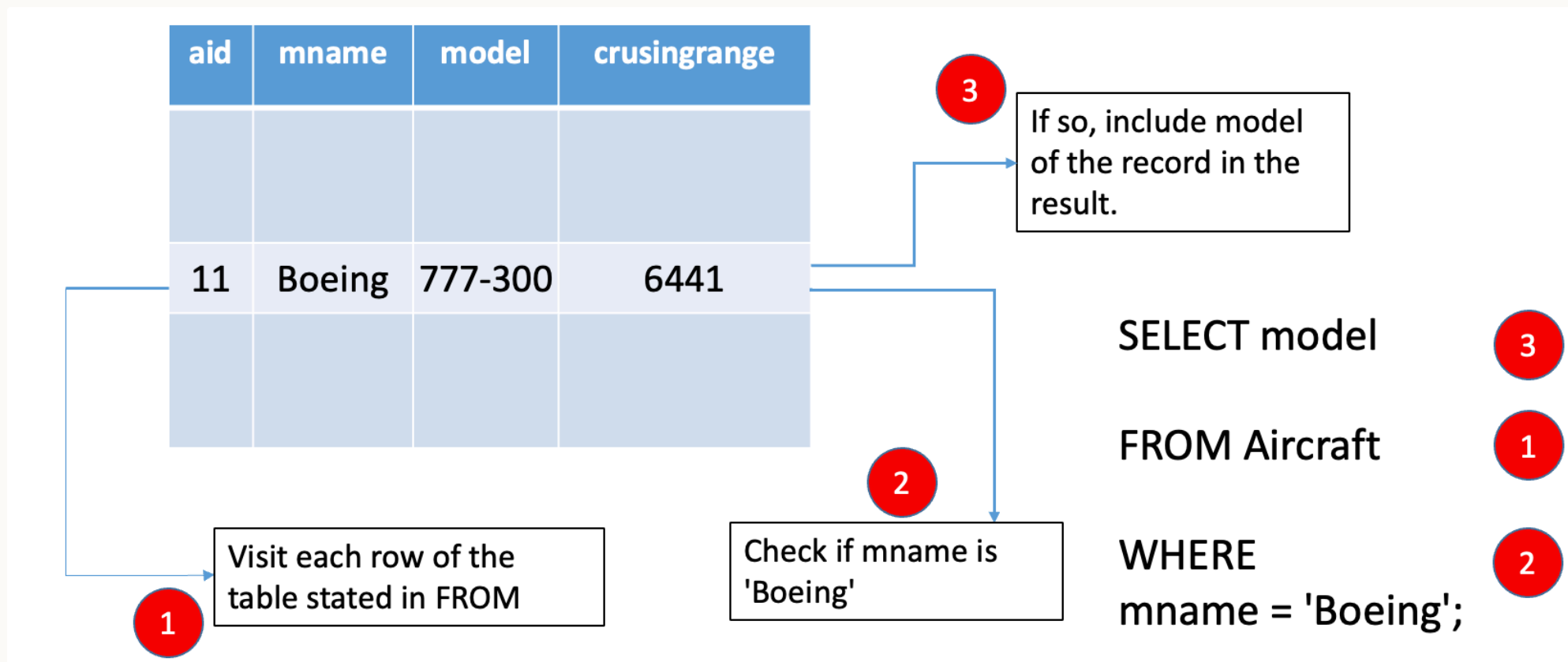
SELECT

```
SELECT what
FROM   table(s)
WHERE  conditions

-- "--" starts a comment to the end of the line
/* and this is a
   multi line comment */
SELECT *           -- "*" means "everything"
FROM   people
WHERE  email is NULL
```

By far the most complex SQL feature – covering basics today, more next week ...

How does SELECT work?



What about multiple tables?

What does this do?

```
SELECT * FROM flight, pilot
```

Need to *join* the tables using a *join condition*

A SQL query goes into a bar,
walks up to two tables and asks...

“Can I join you?”

Join condition

```
SELECT * FROM flight, pilot WHERE flight.pilotID=pilot.pilotID
```

FLIGHT

<u>Flight Number</u>	<u>Day</u>	<u>PilotID</u>	<u>Plane Model</u>
NZ123	10 Aug 2018	PL8715	Airbus310
NZ456	11 Aug 2018	PL8716	Airbus320
YA789	17 Aug 2018	PL9781	Boeing737
NZ123	12 Aug 2018	PL9781	Boeing737
N124	13 Aug 2018	PL9781	Airbus310
YA890	17 Aug 2018	PL9781	Airbus310

PILOT

<u>PilotID</u>	<u>PilotName</u>
PL8715	Pat Smith
PL8716	Yi Zhang
PL9781	Jim Belich

Join condition - query result

```
SELECT * FROM flight, pilot WHERE flight.pilotID=pilot.pilotID
```

<u>Flight Number</u>	<u>Day</u>	Pilot ID	Plane model	Pilot Name
NZ123	10 Aug 2018	PL8715	Airbus310	Pat Smith
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NZ123	12 Aug 2018	PL9781	Boeing737	Jim Belich
NZ124	13 Aug 2018	PL9781	Airbus310	Jim Belich
YA890	17 Aug 2018	PL9781	Airbus310	Jim Belich
...	...	...	...	...

Join condition - 3 tables

```
SELECT DISTINCT pilotName
FROM flight, pilot, aircraft
WHERE flight.pilotID=pilot.pilotID
AND flight.planeModel=aircraft.planeModel
AND planeManufacturer='Airbus'
```

	pilotName
1	Pat Smith
2	Jim Belich

PILOT

PilotID	PilotName
PL8715	Pat Smith
PL8716	Yi Zhang
PL9781	Jim Belich

AIRCRAFT

Plane Model	Plane manufacturer
Airbus310	Airbus
Airbus320	Airbus
Boeing737	Boeing

FLIGHT

Flight Number	Day	PilotID	Plane Model
NZ123	10 Aug 2018	PL8715	Airbus310
NZ456	11 Aug 2018	PL8716	Airbus320
YA789	17 Aug 2018	PL9781	Boeing737
NZ123	12 Aug 2018	PL9781	Boeing737
N124	13 Aug 2018	PL9781	Airbus310
YA890	17 Aug 2018	PL9781	Airbus310

FLIGHTINFO

Flight Number	Airline	Time
NZ123	Air NZ	10am
NZ456	Air NZ	11am
YA789	Yugoslav Air	10:30am
NA124	Air NZ	11pm
YA890	Yugoslav Air	4pm

PILOT

<u>PilotID</u>	PilotName
PL8715	Pat Smith
PL8716	Yi Zhang
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AIRCRAFT

Plane Model	Plane manufacturer
Airbus310	Airbus
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FLIGHTINFO

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FLIGHT

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NZ456	11 Aug 2018	PL8716	Airbus320
YA789	17 Aug 2018	PL9781	Boeing737
NZ123	12 Aug 2018	PL9781	Boeing737
N124	13 Aug 2018	PL9781	Airbus310
YA890	17 Aug 2018	PL9781	Airbus310

Summary

- `CREATE TABLE` and `ALTER TABLE` – define the structure of a table (its *schema*)
- `INSERT INTO`, `DELETE FROM`, `UPDATE` – change the data in the table
- `SELECT` – query data

Next: activities in part 2 today – learn by doing. Next week, more SQL, focusing on `SELECT`.

Activities

Activity – normalisation

~20 minutes, in groups

- Identify the dependencies in the table on the next slide – assume the primary key is Flight Number and Day.
- How would you transform it into 3NF? Identify functional dependencies, classify them, and split to remove partial and transitive dependencies.

Assumptions: a flight number always flies at the same time; a flight number does not always use the same plane model. What else do you need to assume?

<u>Flight Number</u>	Airline	<u>Day</u>	Time	Pilot ID	Plane model
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...	...	...	...	...	...

Activity – SQL

~30 minutes, individually or in groups

1. Go to learn.datastax.com/ and login if needed
2. Select your own workspace (`user_[username]`)
3. Create the flight DB using [this file](#) (i.e. open the file, copy the contents, and execute as an SQL query) [it's also in Nuku under [Class 3](#)]
4. Write a simple SELECT query to find all flight numbers flown by AirNZ (hint: use the flightinfo table)
5. Write a SELECT query to find all pilotIDs who fly for AirNZ (hint: combine the flight and flightinfo tables, building on your previous query)
6. Modify the previous query to find the *names* of all pilots who fly for AirNZ (hint: join three tables - flight, flightinfo, and pilot)